

Section 1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose of this Manual

This manual is for the use of Revenue officials dealing with all aspects relating to the importation of goods and it is intended to outline the general rules applicable to imports. Additional instructions will, apply in relation to particular procedures and this manual contains an appropriate cross-reference to the other manuals where necessary. A full list of all the supporting material to this manual is contained in [Appendix 2](#).

The manual will help you to understand the procedures and customs formalities involved when importing goods.

1.1.1 Brexit

In January 2021, the UK officially left the European Union and is now a non-EU country.

Provisions relating to Northern Ireland are covered by the revised Protocol to the Withdrawal Agreement effective from 1 January 2021. The effect of the Northern Ireland Protocol allows for goods originating in Northern Ireland to be treated as Union goods when trading with the EU and vice versa.

The United Kingdom (UK) and European Union (EU) have formally adopted the [Windsor Framework](#), which came into effect on 25 March 2023. The EU-UK Trade and Cooperation Agreement, effective from 1 January 2021, has eliminated tariff duties for trade between the EU and the UK where the relevant rules on origin are met. Further information on these rules can be found on the [Revenue website](#).

Further details on the topic of Brexit can be found on the [Revenue website](#).